

CLEVERCLIMB SEO — BRAND-NEW SITE EXECUTION PLAN

(Founder-led, goal-driven, PDF-aligned)

PHASE 1: DEFINE THE BUSINESS DIRECTION (NON-NEGOTIABLE)

Goal I set as founder:

CleverClimb must attract **South African businesses** that want to understand SEO and eventually invest in it.

This means:

- We do **not** chase vanity traffic
- We do **not** narrow ourselves to one city on day one
- We position CleverClimb as:
 - Educational
 - Trustworthy
 - Process-driven

This aligns with the PDF's insistence on **goals before keywords** .

PHASE 2: DEFINE OUR AUDIENCE (BEFORE KEYWORDS)

Founder decision:

CleverClimb's primary audience is:

- Small to medium South African businesses
- Owners / decision-makers
- People who:
 - Have heard of SEO
 - Don't fully understand it
 - Are researching options

This immediately tells me:

- Homepage = **awareness** + **evaluation**
 - NOT aggressive sales
 - NOT city-locked
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PHASE 3: DEFINE WHAT WE SELL (IN USER LANGUAGE)

The PDF stresses this point heavily.

Founder framing (important):

We do **not** sell:

- “Rankings”
- “Backlinks”
- “Packages”

We sell:

- Visibility
- Growth
- Sustainable acquisition through search

So the language on the homepage must reflect:

- What SEO is
 - Who it’s for
 - How it fits into digital marketing
 - Why CleverClimb’s approach is different
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PHASE 4: BUILD THE INITIAL KEYWORD UNIVERSE (NO TOOLS YET)

Because this is a new site, I start **internally**, exactly as the PDF says.

As founder, I define three intent layers:

1. Awareness keywords

People learning:

- What is SEO
- What does SEO do
- Is SEO worth it
- What is digital marketing
- SEO vs PPC

2. Evaluation keywords

People comparing:

- SEO services South Africa
- SEO agency South Africa
- Digital marketing agency South Africa

3. Transactional keywords (future)

People ready to act:

- SEO services
- Local SEO services
- SEO audit

⚠ Important founder decision:
These layers **do not live on the same page**.

PHASE 5: HOMEPAGE STRATEGY (CORRECTED & CONFIRMED)

Founder decision (final):

The CleverClimb homepage will **NOT** target Cape Town.

Why:

- We are not based there
- It narrows perceived reach
- It conflicts with awareness intent
- It belongs on a dedicated page

Homepage purpose:

Introduce SEO and digital marketing, explain who it's for, and position CleverClimb as a trusted guide.

Homepage keyword direction:

- Broad
- National
- Non-local
- Educational + commercial blend

Examples (directional, not final list):

- SEO services South Africa
- SEO agency South Africa
- Digital marketing services South Africa

These are **evaluation-stage**, not hard-sell.

PHASE 6: CONTENT STRUCTURE I COMMIT TO

Homepage will include:

- What SEO is (plain language)
- Who SEO is for
- How SEO, PPC, and social media fit together
- CleverClimb's values & approach
- Clear pathways to:
 - SEO services page
 - Local pages (later)
 - Educational content

This aligns with the PDF's emphasis on:

- Matching content to **searcher intent**
 - Serving users before chasing rankings .
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PHASE 7: LOCATION PAGES COME AFTER FOUNDATION

Founder roadmap decision:

Only **after** the homepage and core service pages are live, I expand into:

- SEO Cape Town
- SEO Johannesburg
- Other strategic locations

These pages will:

- Be transactional
- Be location-specific
- Have their own intent and content

They will **not** dilute the homepage.

PHASE 8: METRICS I CARE ABOUT (NOT YET RANKINGS)

Because this is a new site, my **initial success metrics** are:

- Indexation
- Engagement
- Time on page
- Click-through to service pages

Not:

- ✗ Rankings
- ✗ Volume
- ✗ Vanity metrics